national capitalist groups in contradiction to the global capitalist economy and the transnational capitalist class. Interstate conflict in the new era is more likely to take place between the centres of military power in the global system and those states where nationally oriented elites still exercise enough control to impede integration into global capitalist circuits, such as in Iraq prior to the 2003 US invasion or in North Korea, or in those states where subordinate classes exercise enough influence over the state to result in state policies that threaten global capitalist interests, such as in Venezuela and other South American countries that turned to the left in the early 21st century.

Breaking with nation-state-centric analysis does not mean abandoning analysis of national-level processes and phenomena or interstate dynamics. It does mean that we view transnational capitalism as the world-historic context in which these play themselves out. It is not possible to understand anything about global society without studying a concrete region and its particular circumstances – a part of a totality, in its relation to that totality. Globalisation is characterised by related, contingent and unequal transformations. To evoke globalisation as an explanation for historical changes and contemporary dynamics does not mean that the particular events or changes identified with the process are happening all over the world, much less in the same ways. It does mean that the events or changes are understood as a consequence of globalised power relations and social structures. As each country transforms its social relations and institutions, it enters a process conditioned by its own history and culture. Thus uneven development determines the pace and nature of local insertion into the global economy. The key becomes their relationship to a transnational system and the dialectic between the global and the local. Distinct national and regional histories and configurations of social forces as they have historically evolved mean that each country or region undergoes a distinct experience under globalisation.